



6th

2026, One last roar: Against Egypt, Argentina was staring down a stunning World Cup exit after falling 2-0 behind. Then Messi intervened, pulling one back before equalising in the 83rd minute to ignite a comeback that Enzo Fernandez completed in stoppage time. It would turn out to be Messi's final World Cup goal, one last act of defiance before the curtain fell. GETTYIMAGES

7th

2026, The final goodbye: And then came the final chapter. Argentina reached the 2026 World Cup final, only to fall 1-0 to Spain after extra time. Messi stood on the pitch as the dream of another World Cup slipped away, the emotion written plainly across his face. Twenty years after his debut, the journey had finally reached its end.

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